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EL GALLO

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R.U. Conference Held in Denver

The Crusade for Justice Building was the meeting place for the three day conference which took place June 16, 17, 18.

The conference opened Friday evening with a meeting of the Denver area representatives.

Among the things which took place during that meeting was the election of Jose Gonzales as district co-ordinator. Jose is an administrator at Escuela Tlatelolco, as well as a previous candidate on the Denver Raza Unida Party(RUP). Plans were discussed for setting up a Review Committee, which will be reviewing all the potential RU candidates for their prospective offices.

El Plan de Aztlan which has served as the Party's platform will again be the platform, with certain modifications.

One important point that was stressed during Friday's meeting was the importance of having young people in district leadership.

STATE WIDE MEETING

On Saturday 17th, the conference moved into its second day. At this time there was a selection of memmers to a central committee. Those selected were:

South-Martin Serna, Eddie Martinez
Central-Jose Gonzales
North-Jose Calderon
Boulder-Florencio Granados, Ricardo Falcon, Ben Garcia

Sal Carpio, a long time active member of RUP was elected as State coordinator. Speaking during the meeting he mentioned that the future of the party looks good. He said that there is a growing awareness among Chicanos, who he feels are becoming more politicized. He also said he fells that the 18-year vote will show its impact as far as Raza Unida goes.

EIGHT STATES AT CONFERENCE

On the final day of the conference representatives from eight states including Washington, Nebraska, Texas, Idaho, Colorado, Michigan, California, and Illinois came together to discuss the philosophy and the direction of the Party.

Ruben Solis, the RUP candidate for State Treasurer from Texas was chosen to chair the meeting. He opened the discussion directing two questions at the representatives--What is the goal of the party, including the philosophy, and what specific direction should it be taking.

Representatives from the various states expressed their opinions as well as some plans for their locales in answer to the two questions.

Several questions were brought up concerning the issue of "bargaining power." Along these lines it was mentioned that there are some Raza leaders who have chosen to support the Democratic Party because we as Chicanos are now in a position to make deals with the two-party system because of our voting strength.

The consensus arrived at, however, was that the RUP, is an independent party founded on the need to break away from the two-party system which in the past has done nothing but lie to us and has used us for its own advantage.

One representative mentioned the danger which exists because of the Pacification Programs whi h have arisen as the result of our exhibition of strength as a party. "There are those leaders," he said,"Who will be bought off."

Recognizing this danger it was stressed that we need to emphasize the "liberation of our minds" and the self-determination of our people. Many felt that as an alternative to the so-called liberal presidential candidates responsible for buying off Raza supporters, the RUP should come up with a candidate for the Presidency. This, of course, remains to be decided at the National conference to be held in September.

NATIONAL CONVENTION PLANNED

El Paso, Texas will be the meeting place for a historical event--the 1st Chicano National Political Convention. Anywhere from 5000--10,000 Chicanos are expected to attended

Among the priorities for that convention will be the setting up of a Congreso de Aztlan and the possible selection of a RUP Presidential candidate.

In the meantime every district, every state will be carring on its strategies to prepare Raza voters.

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